MOJO · MAX · VULKAN · ADRENO 710

Mojo and MAX on a phone GPU

How we ran Mojo kernels and Llama 3.2 1B on a Qualcomm Adreno 710: first by retargeting Mojo's output, then through a native compiler target, and how far MAX itself is from the phone.

moto g stylus 5G (2024) · Adreno 710 · Mojo 1.2 and a 1.3 build from source · MAX 26.7 · October 2026

THE QUESTION

Mojo and MAX ship for NVIDIA, AMD and Apple GPUs. Can they reach a phone GPU that only speaks Vulkan and OpenCL?

The device

moto g stylus 5G (2024) with an Adreno 710 GPU, driven over adb from a Mac.

Three drivers

Qualcomm’s stock Vulkan 1.1, Mesa Turnip (Vulkan 1.4, side-loaded) and Qualcomm OpenCL 3.0.

The toolchain

Mojo 1.2 and MAX 26.7 as shipped; later, the Mojo compiler built from source.

Five acts

ACT 1

Retarget

Rewrite Mojo’s LLVM IR into Vulkan and OpenCL. 8 kernels pass on 3 drivers.

ACT 2

Llama

Llama 3.2 1B decode: 48 of 48 tokens match PyTorch, 283 ms a token.

ACT 3

MAX

ResNet-18 through MAX on the Mac. No road from MAX to the phone.

ACT 4

Native target

Mojo built from source with an Adreno target. Same results, no retargeter.

ACT 5

MAX runtime

The compiler side ports. The runtime and the model compiler do not, yet.

> Orange: our own tools around Mojo. Blue: Mojo’s compiler itself, extended.

Act 1 · Borrow Mojo’s LLVM IR



OpenCL branch

mojo2cl.py writes OpenCL C from the same IR, because Qualcomm’s OpenCL accepts no SPIR-V.

On the phone

A small C runner loads the shader, binds the buffers, dispatches and checks every output element.

Why AMD’s gfx90a: its warps are 64 lanes wide, like Adreno’s subgroups, so WARP_SIZE comes out right.

What the retargeter rewrites

In Mojo’s AMD kernel IR	In the Vulkan shader
Raw pointer arguments	Storage buffers at (set 0, binding k)
Scalar arguments	64-bit slots of a params buffer
AMD thread and block registers	SPIR-V builtins: LocalInvocationId, WorkgroupId
Pointer arithmetic	(buffer, element index) pairs, rebuilt at each access
Shared arrays	Workgroup variables
DPP and bpermute lane moves	Subgroup shuffles; warp.sum becomes one reduction
s_barrier	OpControlBarrier, semantics patched in the binary
64-bit integers	32-bit for the stock driver, which has no int64

The core problem: Vulkan has logical addressing. A shader may not do pointer arithmetic.

Bugs in the way, and how we got around them

LLVM 22

Barrier semantics Vulkan rejects

Patched in the SPIR-V binary.

LLVM 22

Loop strength reduction crashes it

llc -disable-lsr.

LLVM 22

if/elif chain, invalid structured CFG

Kernel rewritten as one if/else.

Stock driver

Two 16-bit shared arrays overlap

Pad to 4 bytes per element.

Stock driver

No reconvergence after loops

Uniform loops, shared-memory reductions.

Stock driver

No 64-bit integers

Index math narrowed to 32 bits.

> Each one stopped a kernel cold or gave wrong answers. None is Mojo’s fault.

Eight kernels pass on all three drivers

SGEMM, 1024 × 1024 × 1024 fp32, ms per run

Kernel	Turnip	Stock	OpenCL
Naive	669	200	409
Shared tiles	233	293	396
fp16 tiles	213	293	343
Register tiles	**32.5**	65.7	67.0

Also passing: vector add, vec4 loads, warp sum, block sum.

66

GFLOP/s, the best SGEMM: register tiles on Mesa Turnip

Act 2 · Llama 3.2 1B on the phone’s GPU

Export
fp16, fused q/k/v and gate/up: 2.47 GB, 103 tensors

→

7 Mojo kernels
embed, rmsnorm, gemv, gemv_add, rope_kv, attention, silu_mul

→

llama_vk.c
398 lines of C: buffers, pipelines, 150 dispatches a token

→

Check
tokens and logits against PyTorch fp32

Small kernels

All of decode is 219 lines of Mojo. The GEMVs read nearly every weight byte, and end in warp.sum.

Driver limits shape the export

The stock driver binds at most 128 MB, so the 525 MB embedding table is split into 4 chunks.

LLAMA 3.2 1B, DECODED ON THE ADRENO 710

48/48

generated tokens identical to PyTorch

283 ms

per token, 3.5 tokens a second, on both Vulkan drivers

55%

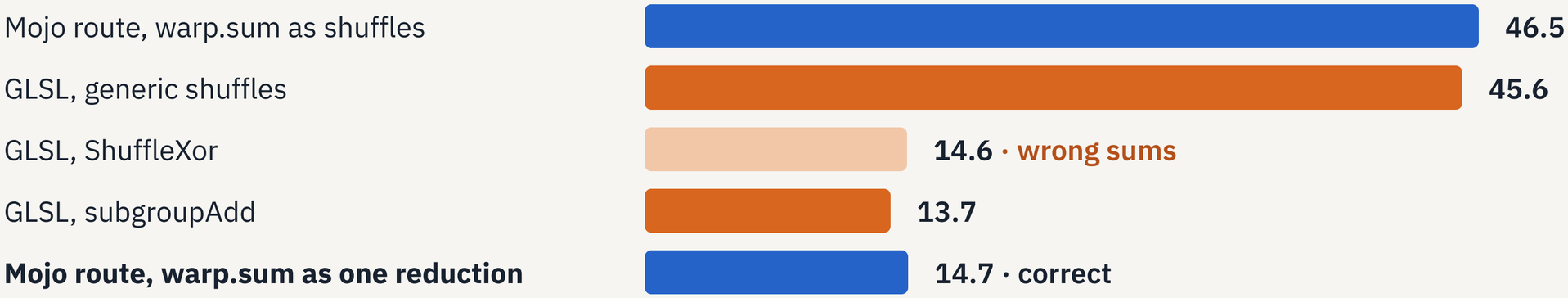
of the memory-bandwidth limit, 156 ms a token

> “The sky appears blue because of a phenomenon called Rayleigh scattering, in which shorter wavelengths of light, such as blue and violet, are scattered more…”

Mojo and MAX on Adreno · 9 · prompt of 46 tokens in 11.5 s · logits within 6.2e-5 of PyTorch

A 4.9× slowdown was one lowering

Stock driver · one 64 MB fp16 GEMV, ms per dispatch · the same kernel in GLSL as the yardstick



> Llama on the stock driver: **1,392 → 285 ms a token**, still 48 of 48 tokens right.

Act 3 · How MAX runs a model



ResNet-18 through MAX 26.7	Result
Mac CPU	**18 ms** an image · error 8.9e-7 against NumPy · same top-1 class
Compile time	66.5 s the first time, 1.0 s from the cache
Mac GPU (Apple)	compile failed, even for one relu: Xcode’s Metal compiler is not installed
Adreno 710	no target · and no ONNX import in 26.7 either

Where MAX stopped in 26.7

No SPIR-V target

Mojo’s compiler linked LLVM’s NVPTX, AMDGPU and Apple backends, not SPIR-V.

No Android runtime

MAX shipped for macOS and Linux hosts, with no Vulkan or OpenCL device.

Opaque internals

The 1.2 binary cannot dump Mojo’s MLIR, so a retargeter had to start at LLVM IR.

Vendor-tuned kernels

MAX’s library kernels lean on tensor cores, matrix cores and async copies.

> So Llama ran on our own C runtime, and every kernel went through the retargeter.

ACT 4 · THE COMPILER OPENED UP

18 Aug 2026

Modular open-sourced the Mojo compiler, a week after Mojo 1.0. The graph compiler, runtime and kernels sit beside it in modular/modular.

Codegen plugin
emits code for a new device

stdlib hooks
thread ids, math, printing

MAX hooks
warp size, barriers, shuffles

Driver plugin
runs code on the device

Mojo and MAX on Adreno · 13 · Apache 2.0 with LLVM exceptions · there is no Mojo 2.0; the latest release is 1.2

What we added: an adreno710 target

C++ · 1,256 LINES

In the compiler

Target traits, kernel marking, and a backend whose 840-line pass turns each kernel into a Vulkan entry point.

MOJO · 406 LINES

Two plugins

stdlib: ids as SPIR-V builtins, math as GLSL.std.450. MAX: 64-lane warps, barrier, shuffles.

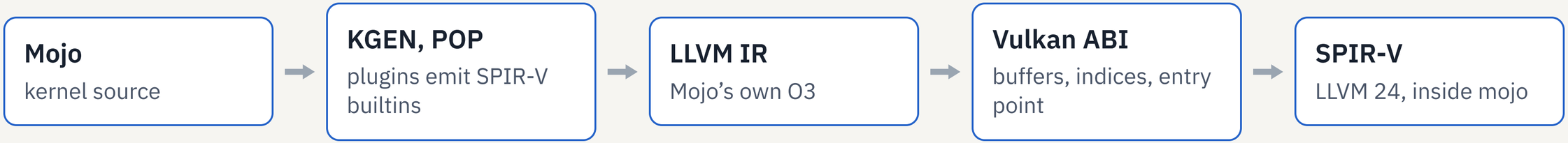
MAX · 33 LINES

One new hook

warp_sum_fn: a target can give warp.sum one native reduction, so no pattern matching.

```
$ mojo build --emit asm --target-accelerator adreno710 kernel.mojo
# one ready-to-load .spv per kernel, validated by spirv-val
```

The native pipeline, inside one compiler



What the target gains

The kernel is compiled for the Adreno from the start: its warp size, builtins, math and barrier are chosen by the target, with full types.

What disappears

The AMD stand-in target, text IR parsing, lane-move pattern matching, the barrier binary patch.

What it took to match the retargeter

Problem	Effect	Fix
Index as a 64-bit byte offset, then divided	naive SGEMM 2.6× slower	index from the GEP’s terms, in 32 bits
Device-scope barrier	block sum 2× slower	workgroup-scope barrier
LLVM 24: strength reduction, misplaced merge	crash, invalid SPIR-V	codegen at -O0; IR already optimized
Pointer phis from Mojo’s optimizer	compile error	phis of element indices
No print hook for debug_assert	compiler crash	print hook that drops output
Integer store of float bits	invalid SPIR-V	bitcast to the element type
No math hooks	logits off by 2.1e-4	exp, sqrt, … as GLSL.std.450

> Six were gaps in our new target; one is two LLVM 24 bugs.

Native target vs retargeter, same driver

Kernel	Native target	mojo2vk	Check
Vector add	1.6–1.7	1.7–2.2	pass
vec4 add	11.1	10.0	pass
Warp sum	2.31	2.30	pass
Block sum	**6.3**	13.7	pass
Naive SGEMM	670	670	pass
Shared-tile SGEMM	230	234	pass
fp16-tile SGEMM	**183**	216	pass
Register-tile SGEMM	34.4	34.9	pass

Faster where barriers dominate: the native barrier orders shared memory only.

Mojo and MAX on Adreno · 17 · Mesa Turnip · ms, median of 20 runs · SGEMMs 1024^3 · vector add varies run to run

LLAMA 3.2 1B, EVERY KERNEL FROM MOJO'S OWN COMPILER

283.6 ms
per token natively, against 285.0 through the retargeter

48/48
tokens identical to PyTorch

6.2e-5
largest logit error, the same as before

> Same weights, same 398-line runtime, same Turnip driver. Only the compiler changed.

Mojo and MAX on Adreno · 18 · same session, same phone · 46-token prompt: 11.35 s native, 11.37 s retargeted

Act 5 · Is MAX itself portable now?

MAX layer	On the Adreno today
Mojo compiler and stdlib	**Yes** · the adreno710 target
max.gpu: ids, barriers, warp ops	**Yes** · through the plugins
Kernel library: matmul, softmax, conv…	**Partly** · 16 of 25 test graphs, next slide
Graph compiler	**Runs** · for a virtual Vulkan device
Runtime: devices, memory, launches	**No** · no Vulkan backend, no Android build
Python API, pipelines	**No** · needs Python on Android, or the C API

> On the phone, kernels are still launched by our own C runners, not by MAX.

Compile test: MAX graphs for vulkan:adreno710

16/25

graphs give valid SPIR-V for every kernel, checked by spirv-val

Graphs	Status
Elementwise ops, transpose, slice, sum, mean, three matmuls, avg pool	**Valid** · 16 graphs
softmax, layer_norm, max_pool2d	One kernel hits LLVM 24’s merge bug
cast, concat, gather, argmax, conv2d, ResNet-18	Not yet: six open issues

Fixes along the way: block-size metadata, a syncwarp hook, an Adreno SIMT matmul branch, tensors passed by value and split into buffers, vector accesses split per element, Vulkan atomic scopes.

What porting MAX’s runtime would take

1 **A Vulkan driver plugin**
61 C functions: devices, memory, queues, kernel loading. CUDA’s and Metal’s are about 2,500 lines each.

2 **An Android build of the runtime**
Cross-compiled for 64-bit ARM Android. The repository has no Android toolchain today.

3 **Compile on the Mac, run on the phone**
Ship the compiled model as a .mef file, so the phone never runs the compiler.

4 **Kernel coverage, then tuning**
Every op a model uses must compile for SPIR-V, then be tuned per driver.

What we learned

LLVM IR is a workable bridge	A retargeter got Llama running on a GPU Mojo never targeted, exactly.
The losses were lowerings	One warp-sum lowering cost 4.9× on Llama; SPIR-V itself cost little.
Drivers decide	Two Vulkan drivers disagree on speed, and twice on correctness. Check every output.
A native target removes fragility	Same speed, no stand-in target, no text patching. SPIR-V's limits remain.
MAX's runtime is the long pole	The plugin design makes a new GPU about 1,700 lines; running MAX models needs much more.

What comes next

The native target

Qualcomm’s stock driver: Vulkan 1.1 and 32-bit index math in the backend. OpenCL C from the same target.

Faster Llama

From 283 toward the 156 ms floor: int4 weights, fused kernels, the prompt as matrix products.

Upstream

Report LLVM 24’s two SPIR-V bugs. Offer Modular the warp-sum hook and the target.

> The question is no longer whether Mojo can reach a phone GPU. It is how much of MAX should follow it there.